

What Makes Petitional Prayer Work

The Lord wanted me to take you tonight into petitionary prayer. I would not have done it this way. I would have run it the way I wanted to, but He wanted me to take you into some petitionary prayer and, in doing so, teach you some things about your own soul.

My spirit can march right into the Holy of Holies. It can go right into His presence. I am there. But sometimes there are things in your soul that do not like to go in there.

So let me teach you some things about what your soul needs to be doing for answered prayer.

When I want edification, I pray in tongues. When I want presence, I worship. Wherever I am, it does not matter. I can get presence just by worshiping.

Edification is the process the Holy Spirit uses through prayer to transform you to the Word of God and cause you to understand it. Worship is different. When I want presence, I worship. With edification, I do not necessarily feel things all the time. Sometimes I do, and at other times I go through a season in a prayer vigil when I do not feel much. A string of tongues comes out of me, and I lie there and pray.

It is not any less effective whether you feel anything or not. That is not what determines it. Edification is a process. Sometimes you can feel it while it is going on, and sometimes you cannot. It is a building up on your most holy faith, first from the inside outward, until eventually it dominates your soul.

I can teach you some things about your soul that will assist the climb of the Holy Spirit. It will assist His working with you if He can get you to cooperate with Him. It will speed the process of transformation.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Let us begin with Ephesians 5:17, and then put a marker in Matthew 6. We will go there in a moment.

For your information, my lightning-quick mind came to the understanding of Ephesians 5:17-20 in a mere twenty years. So give me fifteen minutes.

Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.
And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;
Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ;
Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.

Notice it says, "Giving thanks always for all things." Should we give thanks to Jesus and the Father God both? Yes. But does that mean giving thanks for the cancer ravaging my body, for the car wreck that broke my back so I cannot preach anymore, or for the cataract that blacked my eye out? That is where people get doctrines like that, from reading verses like this one.

But he also said, "Be not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is." I know what the will of the Lord is concerning healing. I know what it is concerning righteousness. I know what it is concerning prosperity. So the thanks I give must be for the things contained within the will of the Lord.

"Lord, I thank You for healing me. Lord God, I thank You my name is written in heaven and I am the righteousness of God in Christ. I thank You for answered prayer."

Whenever you are reading along with your carnal mind and suddenly read something that throws you into a ditch, that usually has the most in it. How do you know? Because you did not understand it.

Paul says, "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess," but then he gives the alternative: be filled with the Spirit. He not only gives the alternative, he tells you how:

Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord,
giving thanks.

You are ministering to yourself. You are the receptor. You are ministering to your own soul in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, making melody in your heart to the Lord and giving thanks for the things contained within His will.

For years, many of us preachers used those verses when people fell down or staggered around under the anointing. Somebody would say, "My God, he is drunk on the new wine." I would say, "Yes, I have my own stash." Elderberry wine, squeezed out by the elders during prayer.

But the subject here is ministering to your own soul in thanksgiving for answered prayer.

In case you think the confessions you are making in psalms, hymns, and thanksgiving for answered prayer have nothing to do with the senses, they do. In case you think your confession was designed to move God, you are wrong. He already completed the answer to your prayer two thousand years ago. He is not the problem. He wanted to answer it when you thought it.

What is my confession moving? Not God. He is not stuck. That is why Paul said you are speaking to yourself. The subject is the senses.

How do you know? Because he said, "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess." When a man in the world drinks wine, what part of him becomes intoxicated? What part of him is affected if not his physical senses?

Here is a little guy who looks like Wally Cox. He goes into a bar, and five tequilas later he thinks he is John Wayne. He is going to go down and whip Arnold Schwarzenegger at the end of the bar. His senses have failed him. He is about to find out that they are not representing things in the true light in which they exist.

His senses are no longer capable of evaluating things in the true light because they have come under subjection to intoxication. That is what the world does to escape problems. They go to the bottle and drown their problems so they can face each day.

But God says, "You do not have to do that. You can turn to the Holy Ghost and bring your senses so under subjection to the Word of God by the power of the Holy Spirit that you begin thinking about the problem the same way God thinks about it. You are not reasoning like the world anymore."

I have seen Vietnam veterans who never recovered. My tour with Vietnam was a cruise through the Formosa Straits, and they shot some shells over our ship. But Vietnam was horrible. Men crawled through the sweat and humidity, never knowing if somebody four feet away was going to put a bullet in them. They lived like that from moment to moment, and most people's systems are not designed to take that.

Then they came home to an appreciative America. You cannot know what that would do to a man.

Many of them gave up. Some are in institutions and cannot function. Many who are not in institutions are alcoholics. Sometimes you run into them in gutters.

"Mister, can you give me a couple of dollars? I am awful hungry."

"I know your game. I am going to go buy you food because I know you are just going to get a bottle of wine."

"All right, you caught me. I am a Vietnam vet. They sent kids into the camp with grenades, and they blew up in front of us. I saw little skeletons glow on the horizon just before the phosphorus bomb melted them down. I have seen atrocities human beings did to each other. I was tortured. If I do not keep my senses sedated with wine, if I sober up, I will commit suicide."

That is the way your soul is designed. Your soul will transform to cause you to survive in your surroundings.

If you do not speak the language and someone throws you into a country with no translator, your soul will transform you to that language without you even trying. Eventually you will begin to speak it.

If you hang around television all day while you are dying of a disease, you will transform to what it is saying. Your soul has the power to transform you to what you give yourself to the most. That is how it operates.

That is why God says, "The world has to sedate their senses to survive, but you do not have to. You can minister to your own soul in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs."

There is a place with Him, in His presence, where your senses can come so under the subjection of the Word of God that you need no outside evidence that you are healed. You need no outside stabilization for your emotions to know you have received your miracle. The Holy Spirit can assist you in bringing your senses so under subjection to the Word of God that you will be healed.

Here is where some of our problems come in. Some of us have children we call special children. We try to make them comfortable in the world. It is not fair to them. They do not have the same start out of the gate that you have.

Nevertheless, like Mary Baxter, we have a covenant. We do have a covenant. It is the church that has failed them.

When Mom and Daddy get up every day and bathe that child every day, every day, every day, it is nothing like your lifestyle. Their senses become so programmed with the problem that they need more than a pat on the back. They need more than, "Keep your confession up, brother." They need to enter into a relationship with the Father in such a way that their emotions undergo a transformation until hope can receive the substance of faith and they come out of that thing.

Will it happen? Yes.

He said to minister to yourself in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, making melody in your heart to the Lord.

What would I do? Let me capsulize it for a moment.

I have my covenant. I believe what God said. If it is not working, I cannot just stand there and dance around it. I do not know what it is. Maybe it is the teacher in me. Maybe I am normal. Maybe I am not. But I cannot dance around my covenant and watch kids grow up sick in my church if it is real. If this gospel is only for good-looking people who drive Lexuses, sit in restaurants, buy steaks, and talk about how good God is to them, I do not want it.

Those children have a covenant.

What is the problem? You have become so transformed with the problem that you cannot see the answer. It is before you every day. It has literally strung your senses out.

What are you going to do? You are going to have to go into God and give Him equal time.

If I were in that situation with my son or daughter, I think my stubborn streak is wide enough and my God is alive enough. I will tell you what I would do. The big house, the swimming pool, and the Lexus would go. I would get an apartment, put my wife in one bedroom and the child who needed the miracle in the other. I would put the money in the bank, buy a little Volkswagen to drive around town, buy groceries, pay the rent, and report to the prayer closet at six o'clock every morning.

I would worship God and minister to my own soul ten or twelve hours a day if necessary.

How would I worship Him? I would get the psalms, hymns, and all the verses that describe the victory. I might spend four hours just telling Him how much I love Him first. Then I would get the Word out pertaining to Him, and for the next seven hours I would worship Him and thank Him that my boy is healed because He is not a man that He should lie.

"What if you run out of money by then?"

I would have formed a tax-free corporation, taken time to raise some money, put it in the bank, bought groceries, and gone home.

Do you have a petition you want to present before Him? How do you approach Him? You would learn if you locked yourself up that many days. But if I were to teach you to present a petition in the next thirty minutes, how would you do it?

Some of you quit bothering to petition God or pray about things. You just kind of exist with Him. "I love God." Some of us get so worn out by things that we cannot really remember the last time we could swear by God that He answered a prayer. We have to make up things like, "He knows better than I do, so He let this happen instead of what I wanted."

That does not describe most of the Bible. Some of us, if indicted for answered prayer, probably could not be convicted yet. Learn how to operate.

Why sit there and let things go by?

If I want to present my soul, the conscious part of me, my mind, will, intellect, and emotions, before God, am I merely going to tell Him what I want? No. I am going to present that part of me before Him and know that I have it.

We have become disrespectful. A man says, "Oh God, bless this meal," and pretty soon it is just, "Bless it." Then it is "blessed." But you are not only serving a King. You are serving a Redeemer. You are not only serving God. You are serving your Father.

Try to have some respect.

I want you to start thinking right now. Get one flesh before your mind: your mother, father, sister, brother, husband, wife, or children. Very rarely are they all saved. I want you to get one flesh in your mind. Get ready to petition. Have that person in your heart and be ready to give them over to God when we get to that part.

If I can so subject my senses to the Word of God by the power of the Holy Spirit, and if He can assist me to do this, I will receive answered prayer. There is not a thing this side of hell the devil can do to stop it.

Go to Matthew 6. Hallelujah, Jesus.

Is anybody having as good a time as I am? Oh yes. You could hear a mouse stomp through here and you would think it was an elephant.

Let us begin with verse 6:

But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet,
and when thou hast shut thy door,
pray to thy Father which is in secret;
and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

Verse 7:

But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do:
for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.

He was speaking of chanting. That is the way cults get demon-possessed. He did not want them to carry that into Christianity. He is your Father, and you are His son. It is not that kind of relationship.

Verse 8:

Be not ye therefore like unto them:
for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.

He knows what things you have need of before you ask Him. So it must not be so much the need as how you are approaching Him to ask. It must not be the need as much as the condition of your heart and what is present in you. That is why Jesus went on to teach protocol.

How do you enter the presence of your King? He knows what you have need of before you enter. What are you going to slip past Him that He does not already know?

Verse 9:

After this manner therefore pray ye:

Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.

Holy is Your name.

Then, of course, your prayer must be based on the Word of God:

Thy kingdom come.

Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.

Whatever the cross has bound in heaven, you can bind on earth. Whatever it has loosed in heaven, you can loose on earth. It must be based on the Word. You cannot get ridiculous. Your prayer must be that His will be done in earth as it is in heaven. We know His will because He sent His Word here to tell us His will in heaven. I know His will concerning my healing now, so my petition must be based on the Word of God.

Then He says:

Give us this day our daily bread.

That does not mean you get up every day and beg God for your food supply. This is a statement of worship. "Give us this day our daily bread," because You are hallowed. You are my Father, who knows what I have need of before I ever approached You. I want to thank You for being my supplier and for the daily bread You have promised me. Every need I have today has been supplied.

This is what makes it work:

And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.

He said more about that in verse 14:

For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you:

But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

If this is not present, the prayer will not work. He knows what you have need of before you enter His presence, but if you do not walk in forgiveness and forgive debts as He has forgiven you, then just leave the prayer off. Without protocol, it will not work.

Verse 13 says:

Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil:

For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever.

It actually carries the sense of, "Lead us around temptations, testings, and trials, and deliver us from the snares of the evil one." The attributes Jesus just mentioned, worshiping Him as Father and supplier, praying according to His Word, entering His presence with respect, and walking in forgiveness, are the things in your life that cause you to be led around the snares of the evil one. If the devil cannot use those attributes of human character, then he cannot ensnare you.

Then Jesus reiterated forgiveness because it is so important for petitionary prayer. It just will not work without it.

Somebody asked me, "Why can God not overlook unforgiveness with grace? Why is it so devastating?"

I said, "Because it is a violation of the very grace you were born again by."

When the man owed twenty million and could not pay, his master was going to sell him and his family to pay the debt. He begged, and the master forgave him and loosed him. That was the kind of debt Adam put the human race in, and the Father forgave us and loosed us from it. Then that same man grabbed another man by the throat and choked him over a twenty-dollar debt and called him a brother.

The forgiveness of your monumental debt, a debt that could not be paid by a servant of sin, is enough grace to cover every twenty-dollar debt you will ever run into in this life dealing with other human beings. If you do not forgive, then as far as answered prayer is concerned, you have violated the very unmerited, unearnable, undeserved grace by which you were born again.

In Matthew 18, they came to Jesus and asked, "Who is greatest in the kingdom?" In other words, who demands the most respect? Who do the angels salute? Who does heaven reverence? Jesus put a child in the midst and said you have to become like him. Children are quick to forgive and one hundred percent teachable.

He started that teaching on who is greatest in the kingdom and ended it with this statement: you will be turned over to the tormentors if you do not forgive every brother his trespasses from your heart.

I am not talking about walking around with religious talk. I am talking about forgiving from the heart. This is protocol. You are going to enter His presence with your soul, and He told you what makes petition work.

The person esteemed greatest in the kingdom is the one who has made it to the place where he is not talking plastic love, not forgiving because he has to, but has literally forgiven every brother his trespasses from the heart.

God already knows what you need, so what are you going to do, sneak in and say, "I need this, and I need that"? Do you think He does not know already? Since He already knows, what is the problem? That is why Jesus taught you how to pray.

He said to enter with, "Hallowed be Thy name." Show Him the respect due Him. When you bring your soul into His presence, come in with worship.

If I am going to present the conscious part of me into His presence, then I want every part of me to pay attention. When I first started doing this, I began with fifteen minutes because I was not used to doing it. I had to learn how to present my soul. Now I can get lost for hours.

When you look toward heaven and say, "In Jesus' name," that name gives you all redeemed rights. But there is a way to enter the presence of your King. Believe me, He is worthy.

For the first fifteen minutes, I come before Him with "Holy is Your name." He is glad that I am glad devils are subject to me, but He said, "Rejoice first because your name is written in heaven."

So I came before Him, and He had to teach me private worship.

Thank God for public worship, but the worship leader should not have to be a cheerleader. If you will not enter worship unless somebody leads you in, you have made the worship leader a cheerleader. It is a sad day when we do not enter in privately because we have fallen in love with Him.

When I first started coming in to learn protocol, I felt awkward because He knew I had a petition at the end of the worship. He knew what I had need of and what I was going to do. You come in and say, "For these first fifteen minutes, I just want to tell You how much I love You. I do not want to ask for anything. I want to reverence Your name."

You feel awkward because you know that after fifteen minutes or so you are going to ask. You think, "God must think I am setting Him up so I can ask for something."

But He knows all of that, so be honest. He is answering the prayers of the person at home, not the person in church. He is answering the man who goes home, not the man who looks holy in church and then screams at his wife, sits there watching television all day, and lives at that level of faith.

Since He already knows, come clean.

I said, "Father, You know what I am going to do. I need the Holy Spirit to teach me how to offer my soul in worship. While I am in Your presence for these fifteen minutes, there is no part of my soul I will let get by without respecting my King."

Not my intellect. Every second of those fifteen minutes, my intellect is not going to get by with wandering. If it wants to wander, then between each pause of worship I will stop. I will not say, "I love You, Jesus," again until I bring my mind back and make it empty itself into that sentence.

"I love You, Jesus."

If my emotions stray, I bring them back. I empty every part of me that is able to give into that statement. If my will wants to transfer me to something else, I will go get it. I do not care if it takes a full thirty seconds before statements. No part of me will fail to respect being in the presence of my King for those fifteen minutes.

I had to pause between each statement:

"I love You, Jesus. I praise You. I glorify You. I worship You. I adore You. I just want to tell You how much I love You. Thank You for saving me."

After a while, the Holy Spirit rises up and goes into your soul. He starts anointing the attributes of the soul and brings you behind the veil of flesh. He begins to present you in His presence. That is when worship begins. You are inside, and that is where petition is heard.

Glory be to God.

Some of you find it hard to get past fifteen minutes because you have never accustomed yourself to private worship. When I was in Brazil, I got all those kids to stop dancing around to the fast guitars and simply stand there and choose their own words. It got quiet as a church mouse. They did not have anything to say because they did not know Him very well.

It took me a while, but then He came. Now I can enter in very quickly, and sometimes I can get lost for an hour just telling Him how much I love Him, adore Him, glorify Him, and worship Him. The words just gush out.

After a time in His presence, according to protocol, I get the petition out.

"Jesus, I know You have exalted Your Word above Your name. In Psalm 2, when the Father said, 'Thou art My Son; this day have I begotten Thee,' the very first thing Jesus asked for was the heathen for His inheritance. So He has already prayed for your lost loved ones. He wants you to enter into agreement with Him."

That is why I ask you to petition for one flesh, someone close to you.

Now that I have entered His presence in a way that respects my King, when my soul goes in to present a petition, every part of me is going to respect that presence.

I get the name of the person I love, and I use a good faith verse:

What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.

What kind of heaven would heaven be without my one flesh, my son, my daughter, my husband, or my wife? I do not intend to spend eternity without them.

"Father, this is my desire. I receive them to this degree: when I get to heaven, they will either be there already, or they will follow me, but they will be there. You are not a man that You should lie."

Who am I ministering to in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs? My own senses. I am bringing them under subjection to the Word, but now the Holy Spirit is helping me. I am inside.

"You are not a man that You should lie. You said I could say to this mountain. My desire is for them to be saved. I worship You and glorify You and praise You for answered prayer. I am calling my son saved. Thank You for answered prayer. When I get to heaven, he will be there. Have I told You lately how much I love You and worship You and adore You? You are not a man that You should lie. You have exalted Your Word above Your name. Therefore my son is saved.

"Thank You for angels creating an atmosphere around him twenty-four hours a day that is conducive to salvation. You hear my prayers."

Then I worship Him. I may slide off into worship for another hour and then come back and glorify Him for the petition.

What are you doing? You are bringing your senses under subjection to the Word and talking yourself into believing what God said.

Since you know what you want to petition, I will lead you. This is an unusual service for me. We are entering into protocol and petition. With other people I maintain a clock. Alone, I throw it away. When you enter into His presence, you do not want out.

I will tell you the difference between praise and worship. Praise says, "I thank You, Lord, that it is done." If you enter into worship, it turns into gratitude that it is finished. You may not see it yet, but when you get into His presence, your thank-yous turn to gratitude.

I want to encourage you. Every time your intellect gets away from you, bring it back. Gather it together and empty it into each statement. If you cannot think of anything else to say, say, "I love You. I love You, Jesus. Thank You for saving me." That is not vain repetition.

For fifteen minutes, you and I are going to prepare ourselves for a petition. Then we are going to ask. I will lead you. Some of you have never said enough words of praise to carry this by yourself. Believe me, you will learn.

Thank God for the kind of worship we entered into tonight, but can you carry a band around with you? No. You are going to be caught in private worship from time to time.

Let me tell you what public praise can do. It provides everything for you. The song provides the words, so your intellect can hate the person next to you while your mouth sings. The beat provides the emotions, so you can get high on the emotions and not have it be the Spirit of God at all.

But when you enter into private worship and tell Him how much you love Him, "Hallowed be Thy name," for fifteen minutes, you have to reach inside and pour yourself into those statements. You cannot keep hating your neighbor long because you have to participate too much.

Is anybody having a good time?

I am going to start you standing. I do not care if you sit down in the middle of it, but we are going to go fifteen minutes in private worship. That means you are going to reach into your inner sanctuary, pull it out, and tell Him how much you love Him. You are not going to ask for anything. I just want you to tell Him how much you love Him for the next fifteen minutes.

"What if I do not want to?"

Nobody can make you do it. I will be excited to hear next year what He did with your prayer.

We are going to start by singing one song in worship, maybe through it one time, and then you are going to go into your private time of worship for petition. We will all sing together for a minute, and then you will tell Him how much you love Him, singularly, for fifteen minutes.

The first time we led the prayer center into this, it went from fifteen minutes to thirty, then to forty-five. After a while, they did not want to stop.

Father, I am entering into Your presence. You already know why I am here. Holy Spirit, help me present every attribute of my soul. You know what I am going to petition, but I want You to teach me how to worship. I want to enter Your presence for the next fifteen minutes just to tell You how much I love You, Jesus, and how much I adore You, my Father God.

The word hallelujah: Yah is Hebrew for God, Jehovah. Hallelujah is abundant worship and praise to Yah. Hallelujah to the Son. Jesus is worthy. The Father is worthy.

You may burst into tongues once in a while, but major on your soul in His presence.

"I love You, Jesus. Thank You for saving me. I adore You. I glorify You. I magnify Your holy name. Thank You for writing my name in heaven. I worship You, Jesus. Thank You, Holy Spirit, for assisting me. Thank You for taking me into the Holy of Holies. Teach me how to offer my soul in worship: my mind, my will, my intellect, my emotions. Every attribute of my soul will reverence and honor the presence of my King."

Come on. Do not let your soul get away. Bring it back. Present it in the presence of a King. He is worthy of your worship.

"I love You, Jesus. I worship You. Thank You for saving me. I adore You. I glorify You. I bless You. I desire fellowship. Teach me, Holy Spirit, how to offer myself in fellowship."

Some of you are starting to enter in. You are breaking the veil. You are slipping through the flesh into His presence. You are honoring your King. You are giving Him the honor He deserves when you approach Him.

It is not how loud you are. It is how much you are emptying into it. It is how much respect you are giving Him.

Protocol.

"I hate no one. I love. Thank You for the bath You are giving me in the Holy Spirit. I adore You. I glorify You. I magnify You."

Some of you know there are some things wrong that you have to straighten out now, but He will take you. Go ahead. He will take you.

Every part of me is going to pay attention. When I enter His presence to ask Him for something, every part of me is going to reverence that I am in His presence. The part of me that is asking is going to respect my King.

Now do not stop. You are ready for a petition. You can worship Him, giving thanks in psalms, hymns, and worship for answered prayer because you know what His Word says in heaven and on earth. You know that if His Word covers the thing you desire, you can have it.

You know the first prayer Jesus prayed was for the heathen as His inheritance. He wants your lost loved one, so begin to thank Him for it.

"When I get to heaven, they will be there. I worship You, glorify You, and adore You because You are not a man that You should lie. I thank You for saving my son, my daughter, my husband. I thank You that I have my petition.

"Thank You, Jesus, for answering my prayer. I worship You. I adore You. I glorify You. You have exalted Your Word above Your name, and because You have, I know You hear my prayer and it is answered.

"I thank You that my son is saved. I call him saved because You answer prayer. I worship You and adore You and glorify You. I call him saved. You are not a man that You should lie. I thank You with all my heart that my son will spend eternity with me.

"Thank You for creating an atmosphere conducive to his salvation with angels. Thank You that You are moving doctors to talk to my doctor son, lawyers to talk to my lawyer son, race drivers to talk to my race-driver son. You are sending harvesters. You are surrounding him because You answer prayer."

I am helping you. If I were not helping you, I would be off by myself, lost in worship. I am teaching you protocol. He is a King, and He is your Lord. Hallowed be Thy name. Look at yourself; you are being helped.

"Jesus, I thank You for answered prayer because You are not a man that You should lie. You heard me. I have gratitude in my heart, and when I get there, they will be there."

How about it, folks? Do you like the prayer center?

Yes, my senses come under subjection to the Word of God by the power of the Spirit. I am a man intoxicated with God's Word. I am not thinking like the devil anymore. I am thinking like God. I have already crossed the line. My senses are intoxicated with the answer.

"I worship You. I glorify You. I adore You, Jesus. I love You and magnify Your holy name."

If you are lost in worship, then you are lost. We cannot dismiss this service. You will just have to slip out whenever you are ready. Consider yourself dismissed, and slip out of it whenever you do.